

Students should have an understanding of:

1.1	The life of the Buddha: the nature and history of the events in the life of the Buddha and why they are important to Buddhists today, including ancestry, birth, princely life, marriage and the Four Sights, with reference to Buddhavamsa XXVI; the enlightenment of the Buddha and founding of the Sangha.
1.2	Dhamma: the nature and different meaning of dhamma (dependent origination /conditionality); the nature and importance of paticca-samuppada and the Three Marks of Existence, including reference to the Story of Nagasena and the Chariot in the Milinda Panha; suffering (dukkha), no fixed self (anicca) and soul or essence (anatta); the implications of belief in dhamma for Buddhists today.
1.3	First Noble Truth, including reference to the Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta: the nature of dukkha; Buddhist teachings about suffering; the different types of suffering as pain, fabrication and change; the importance of suffering for Buddhists today.
1.4	Second Noble Truth, including reference to Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta: the nature of samudaya (the root of suffering); Buddhist teachings about the causes of suffering, including the Sermon at Benares; the Three Poisons and how they are represented in the Wheel of Life; divergent understandings of the Wheel of Life, with reference to Theravada and Mahayana Buddhism.
1.5*	Third Noble Truth, including reference to the Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta: the nature of nirodha and the cessation of tanha; Buddhist teachings about the ending of desire; the nature of the cycle of samsara; different understandings of nibbana and enlightenment and their importance for Buddhists today.
1.6	Fourth Noble Truth, including reference to the Dhammacakkappavattana Sutta: the nature of the Middle Way (magga); Buddhist teachings about the Eightfold Path leading to nibbana. The Threefold Way: the nature, purpose and importance of sila (ethics), samadhi (meditation) and panna (wisdom); divergent understandings of the importance Eightfold Path and the Threefold Way for Buddhist life today.
1.7	Human life: divergent Buddhist understandings of the nature and importance of the Five Khandas (aggregates), including the Khandha Sutta; divergent Buddhist understandings of the nature and importance of sunnata and tathagatagarbha (Buddha-nature); divergent Buddhist understandings of the nature and importance of Arahant and Bodhisattva Ideals; divergent Buddhist understandings of the nature and history of Buddhahood and the Pure Land.
1.8	Buddhist ethical teachings: divergent Buddhist understandings of the nature, purpose and importance of kamma, including Dhammapada 181–187 and the Khuddakapatha, merit and rebirth, karuna (compassion), metta (loving kindness), pancha sila (the Five Precepts) and the paramitas (Six Perfections); the divergent applications of each of these ethical teachings in Buddhist life today.

Students should have an understanding of:

2.1	The importance and purpose of marriage in Buddhism: divergent understandings of the significance of marriage in Buddhist life; divergent Buddhist teachings about marriage, including its importance, the Sigalovada Sutta, and the possible ideal of celibacy; divergent non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to the importance of marriage in society, including a lack of importance, cohabitation and the Buddhist responses to these attitudes.
2.2	Sexual relationships: Buddhist teachings about the nature and importance of sexual relationships, including reference to the Third Precept, Cunda Kammaraputta Sutta; different attitudes to celibacy, for example Jodo Shinshu monks; divergent Buddhist teachings and attitudes towards sexual relationships outside of marriage and same-sex sexual relationships; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to sexual relationships, including the acceptance of sexual relationships outside marriage and same-sex sexual relationships and Buddhist responses to them.
2.3	Buddhist teaching about the purpose and importance of the family: Buddhist teaching about the purpose of families, including the Sigalovada Sutta; Buddhist responses to the different types of family within 21st-century society (nuclear, single parent, same-sex parents, extended and blended families).
2.4	Support for the family in the sangha, including the role of the sangha as a refuge as taught in The Khuddakapatha 1: how and why the community tries to support families, including through worship, rites of passage, festivals and counselling; divergent understandings of the importance of this support for Buddhists today.
2.5	Buddhist teaching on contraception: divergent Buddhist teachings and attitudes about contraception and family planning, including reference to The Natural World by XIV Dalai Lama; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to family planning and the application of ethical theories such as situation ethics and Buddhist responses to them.
2.6	Buddhist teachings about divorce: divergent Buddhist beliefs, teachings and attitudes towards divorce and remarriage, including A Happy Married Life: A Buddhist Perspective by Ven. K. Sri Dhammananda; non-religious (including atheist and Humanist) attitudes to divorce and remarriage, including the application of ethical theories, such as situation ethics, and Buddhist responses to them.
2.7	Buddhist teachings and attitudes about the equality of men and women in the family: divergent Buddhist beliefs, teachings and attitudes about the role of men and women in the family, including reference to the life of the Buddha and Sigalovada Sutta.
2.8	Buddhist teachings and attitudes about gender prejudice and discrimination, including the Soma Sutta: Buddhist opposition to gender prejudice and discrimination; examples of gender equality in action in Buddhism.